Two fluffy-ruffed cheetahs lounge under a tree, one bright-eyed and alert, the other lolling languorously, safe in the knowledge that its sibling is keeping watch. Beyond the dainty-looking duo, the scrubland stretches to the horizon. For any wildlife enthusiast, a safari in the 1,510 square kilometres of the Maasai Mara National Reserve in Kenya is a bucket-list experience that's worth every rupee spent.

The walkie-talkie on our 4x4 Safari Land Cruiser crackles "Roja, Roja!" (that's how 'Roger' in the local accent sounds) every few seconds. Since the African savannah is so boundless and the animals so plentiful and used to human presence, the game drives here are not conducted in silence as we try to in India. All the safari drivers are constantly on their walkie-talkies, comparing notes and their chorus becomes a part of the gaming experience.



A magnificent African elephant in Maasai Mara